

QUESTION 3: DO YOU HAVE A CLEARLY DEFINED SET OF DAILY, WEEKLY, MONTHLY, ANNUAL, AND LIFETIME GOALS?

The source of this question came from a decamillionaire whom we interviewed a dozen years ago. He told us that he started a wholesale food business at the age of nineteen. He never finished formal high school but did eventually receive his high school equivalency diploma. We asked him to account for the fact that although he was a high school dropout, he had accumulated over \$10 million. His response was as follows:

I have always been goal-oriented. I have a clearly defined set of daily goals, weekly goals, monthly goals, annual goals, and lifetime goals. I even have goals to go to the bathroom. I always tell our young executives that they must have goals.

Mrs. Rule also is goal-oriented. So are most other millionaires. For every 100 millionaires who answered “no” to this question, there are 180 who answered “yes.” Who are the “noes”? Many of the high-income and inherited-wealth types discussed in the last section. Many senior citizens and retired millionaires who have already reached most of their goals also answered “no.” You may wish to reflect for a moment on the comments made by an eighty-year-old multimillionaire:

Authors: The first question we always ask is about goals. What are your current goals?

Mr. Clark: It was \$438 an ounce yesterday in London!

After Mr. Clark turned on his hearing aid, we repeated the question.